



The Oops Moment

Was publicly snubbed by Pranab Mukherjee on parliamentary etiquette for being brusque with a BJP MP, while Sonia watched.

C.P. JOSHI

Minister of Rural Development and of Panchayati Raj

KAVI S. SATHI/WWW.HINDUSTANTIMES.COM

A Trapeze Artist

A sharp administrator, Joshi was brought to the Centre to monitor the UPA's trophy scheme, NREGA. He has chosen his own constituency Bhilwara in Rajasthan, as a laboratory model for converging all the development schemes in his two ministries. Another smart move was to rename NREGA after Mahatma Gandhi. A professor of psychology, Joshi balances his time between his ministry and state politics as Rajasthan Congress chief.

Achievements

■ NREGA is the only scheme to place all its data, including payments made to each worker, on its website. He plans to converge both his ministries and ensure that rural development schemes reach the grassroots.

■ Piloted the amendment to raise reservation for women to 50 per cent in panchayats.

Failures

■ Sonia's favourite amendment Bills, to the Land Acquisition and Relief and Rehabilitation Acts, in limbo.

■ NREGA still has too many loopholes to be plugged despite being Rahul Gandhi's pet legislation. Joshi wants district-level ombudsmen to monitor it but nothing has been done about it.

▼ 57%

Delivery
Meter

FLOP

MEDIOCRE

GOOD

0-33% — 34-64% — 65-100%

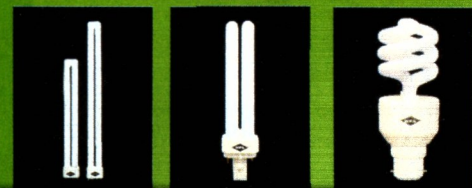


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